EMERGE AI HACKATHON · HEALTHCARE · CHALLENGE 5 · SAT OCT 17 2026

Hear Me Out

The sentence a person needs to see today, read first.

A second listener for health-coaching calls (eMerge Challenge 5, Coach's Copilot). It reads coaching calls in English and Spanish, quotes what needs a human, and a human decides.

Esteban Guio, solo builder, with an AI team

WHAT IT IS

Hear Me Out helps supervisors catch the one sentence on a coaching call that a person must see today.

WHO Coaches and supervisors in health-coaching programs for cancer survivors, in English and Spanish.

PAIN Supervisors cannot re-read every call, so the one sentence that matters can be buried.

WHAT Hear Me Out reads the call, quotes the sentence a person should see today, shows why, and a human decides.

PROOF A live demo, 146 automatic tests, and a published miss rate.

How this differs: scoring tools for coaching conversations already exist (for example Lyssn, per its own materials). Ours adds Spanish and English side by side, quoted safety flags with a human decision step, and a published miss rate. We make no claim to be more accurate than any product.

> **So what for a program:** the people who may need help are read first, not last.

Scenario for illustration: a survivor says “No puedo respirar bien” (I can’t breathe well) and the coach moves on to meal planning. Not a real patient.

ONE CALL, START TO FINISH

Here is what happens to one call, from the raw conversation to a decided follow-up.

Tagger = labels what the coach did on each line. **Flagger** = finds the sentences a person should read today. **FHIR** = a standard format for health records.

1. A coaching call comes in as text, in English or Spanish.

2. The tagger marks what the coach did on each line.

3. The flagger quotes the sentence a person should see today, with the rule that fired.

4. The safety queue sorts calls, so the person starts with who needs a call-back today.

5. The person decides each flag. A ready hand-off note (and an optional FHIR export) is produced.

6. The scorecard shows the coach's practices for that call; across many calls a manager sees patterns.

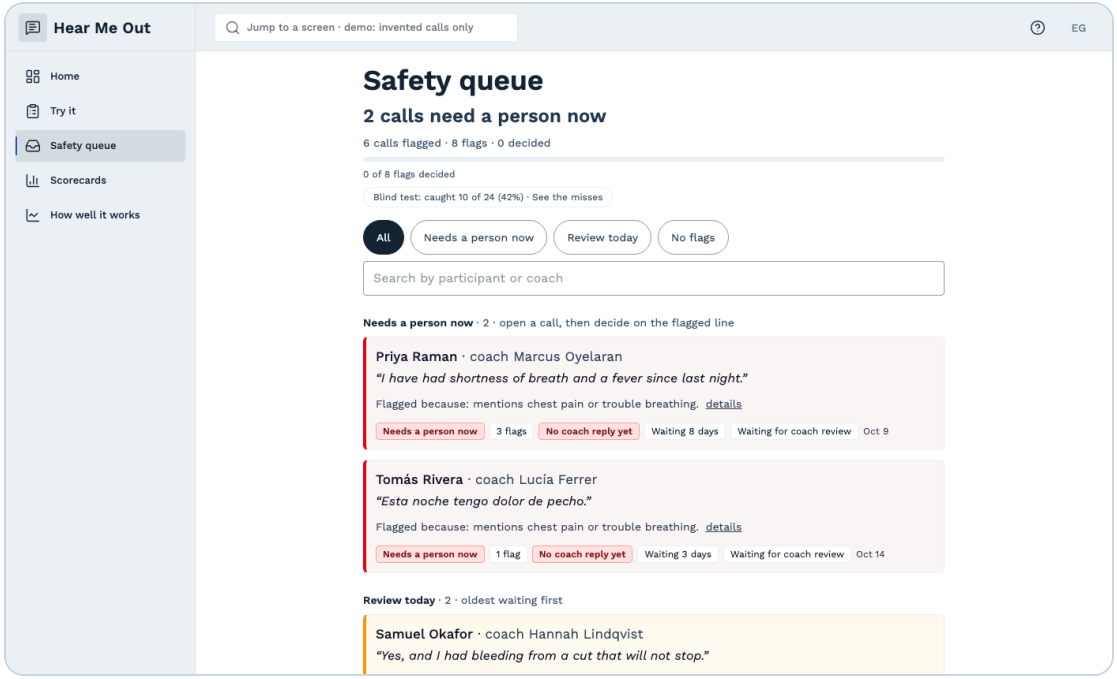
Rules, not learning: the engine is rule-based and does not learn from patient responses. What grows with use is the decision log and the per-coach scorecards, and clinicians review the rules (step two of the plan).

> **So what for a program:** a path from a raw call to a decided, documented follow-up.

Every step is on the live demo, on invented calls.

WHAT IT DOES

Every call becomes a card that quotes the sentence and says what to do next.



Flag = a sentence the tool thinks a person should read today.
Needs a person now = the highest-severity flags, such as chest pain or trouble breathing.

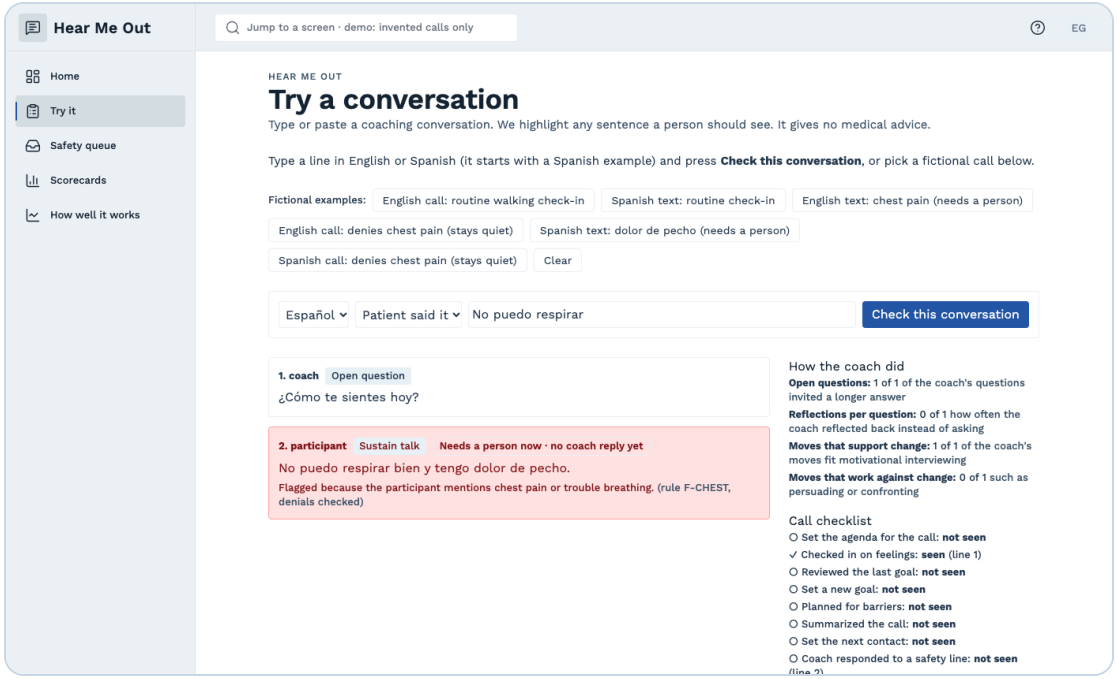
- Calls that need a person now come first, then “review today”, oldest waiting first.
- Each card quotes the sentence, says why it was flagged, and whether the coach has replied.
- It never diagnoses and gives no medical advice.

> **So what for a program:** supervisors start with the calls that matter instead of reading everything.

Screenshot of the live app, Oct 17 2026. All people and calls shown are invented.

LIVE DEMO: “TRY A CONVERSATION”

A Spanish call is flagged for a person in seconds, and a denial stays quiet.



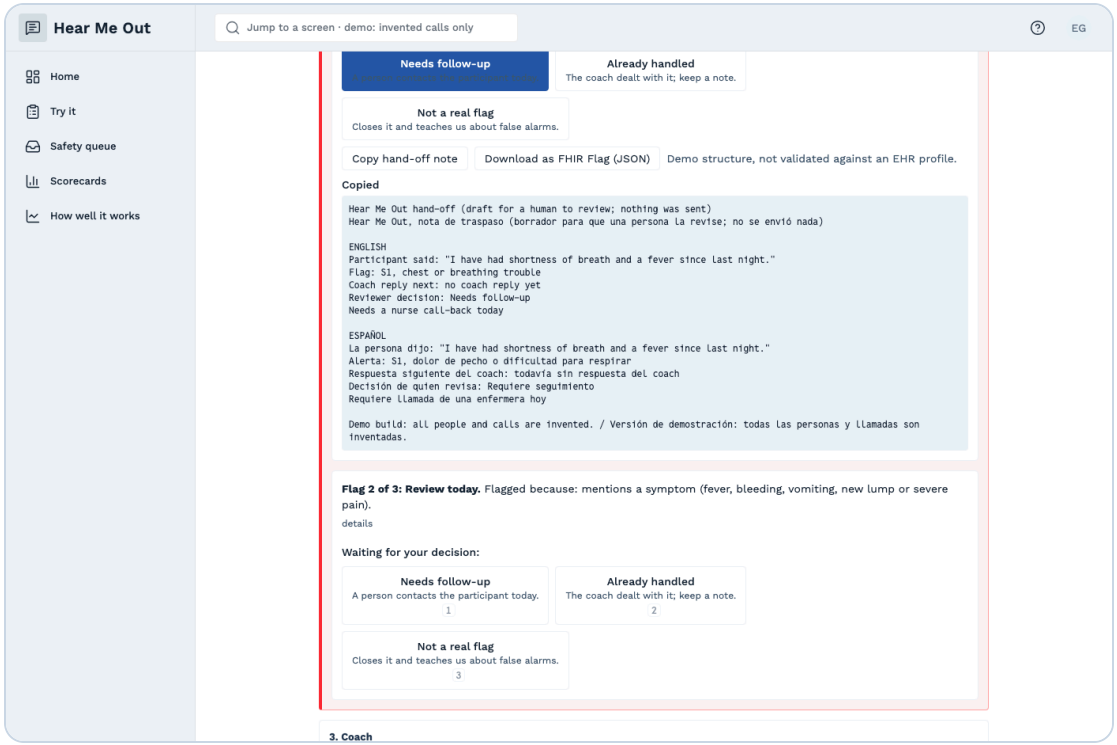
S1 = highest severity. **Unhandled** = the coach has not replied to it yet. **Simple negation** = a plain denial: “no tengo fiebre” (I have no fever) is not a flag.

- Fictional Spanish call: **“No puedo respirar bien y tengo dolor de pecho.”**
- The engine flags it S1, unhandled, shows the rule that fired and quotes the sentence.
- Then a denial stays quiet. Same engine in English.

> **So what for a program:** like a smoke detector, not a firefighter: it does not diagnose, it makes sure a human looks today.

Screenshot of the live app, Oct 17 2026. Fictional lines only; no challenge data is in the app or the public repo.

When a person says yes, the hand-off note is already written, and nothing is sent for them.



Hand-off note = a short summary a nurse or supervisor can paste into their own system.

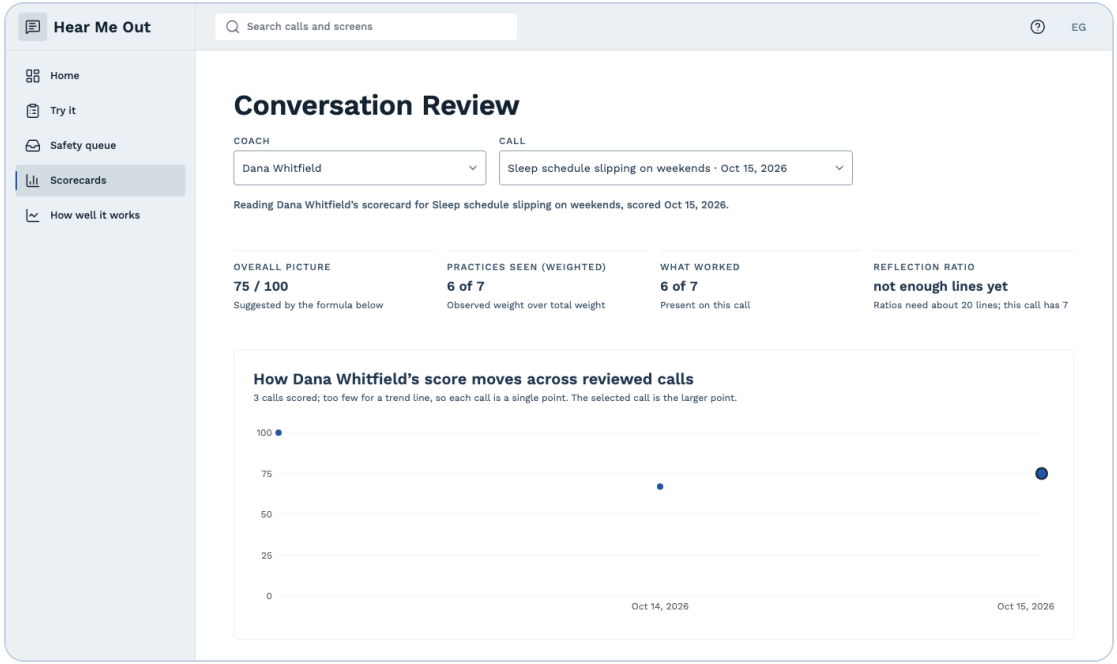
- A person chooses **Needs follow-up** on the flagged line.
- **Copy hand-off note** shows the exact text first, in English and Spanish.
- It is a draft for a human to review. **Nothing leaves the app unless a person pastes it.**

> **So what for a program:** less retyping between the coach and the clinical team, with a human in charge.

Screenshot of the live app, Oct 17 2026. Invented person and call. The note quotes the participant's exact words in the original language; labels and the action are translated.

SCORING THE COACHING

It also scores the coaching and shows its work. It is an aid, not a verdict.



Motivational interviewing (MI) = a coaching style built on open questions and reflecting back what the person said. **Practices seen** = which MI practices the coach used on this call.

- Each call shows practices seen (for example 6 of 7), what worked, and a reflection ratio once there are enough lines.
- An overall picture comes from a formula shown on the page, and counts carry the line numbers behind them.
- It is a coaching aid, **not for HR action**.

So what for a program: a supervisor can coach the coach from specific practices, not just a number.

Screenshot of the live app, Oct 17 2026. Invented coach and call. This page scores the coaching, not the safety flags.

One person, one day, five tools, each one checked.

Tests = automatic checks of the code. **Read-only review** = a second tool reads the code and reports problems but cannot change it.

TOOL	BUILT	WHY THIS TOOL	HOW WE CHECKED IT
Claude Code	Engine (loader, tagger, flagger, score card), API, tests, deploy prep	One owner of main; tests with every module	146 engine tests and 22 evaluation tests pass
Codex	Read-only code reviews, several rounds	An independent second reader that cannot edit	High-severity findings fixed before merge
Devin	Evaluation script (precision, recall, kappa)	Isolated chunk, mock data only	Pull request merged after review
Archie	The interface, from a data-free contract	Fastest route to a usable UI	Wired to our engine, tested in the browser
Render	Free hosting of the public demo	One URL judges can open	Invented data only

Rules, not a model: the safety path never depends on an AI call. A stress test of about 11,000 requests caused no crashes and found three gaps (extra whitespace, full-width text, Spanish crisis phrases); they were then patched.

> **So what for a program:** a program can see which AI tools touched the code and how each was checked.

Source: the repository's AI_TOOLS.md and reviews folder; test counts from a run on Oct 17 2026, 3:56 PM.

THE HONEST NUMBERS

On new phrasings the rules caught 42%, so a human decides every flag.

Tuned set = examples we adjusted the rules while looking at, so it flatters us. **Blind set** = new phrasings written separately and run once. **Caught** = the tool flagged a sentence a person should see (S1 to S3 = all severities; S1 = highest only).

TEST SET (INVENTED TEXT)	CAUGHT (S1–S3)	CAUGHT (S1 ONLY)	FLAGS IT RAISED
Tuned set: 28 cases	100%	100%	19 flags: all 19 right, 0 false alarms
Blind set: 36 new phrasings (24 should flag), run once	**42%** (10 of 24)	**50%** (5 of 10)	It raised 12 flags: 10 were right, 2 were false alarms

Blind set by language: English caught 3 of 12, Spanish caught 7 of 12 (small samples). **The rules catch common wording and miss indirect, informal phrasing.**

> **So what for a program:** plan for misses; use it as a second look, not as a replacement for people.

Source: the app's "How well it works" page, Oct 17 2026. Invented text only; not a claim about real conversations. Blind figures were measured before the later patches; the patches are tested separately.

It is a safety net, not a diagnosis. Here are today’s limits.

Limits

- A human reviews every flag, and decisions are logged.
- Invented data only so far: no live messaging, no real patient data.
- Indirect, informal phrasing is the main known gap in both languages (blind set: English 3 of 12, Spanish 7 of 12 caught). Dialects are untested.
- A miss is not caught by the tool: unflagged calls stay in the program’s normal review. It adds reads, never removes them.
- Rules catch known phrasings; a model second reader that can only add flags is the next step, not built.
- Quality scores are a coaching aid, not for HR action.

Built

- Export of each decided flag as a **FHIR Flag** file (demo structure, not validated against a health-record profile).
- A decision-log download.
- A local mode with no outside calls.

FHIR = a standard format for health records; a Flag file is a standard way to record an alert.

> **So what for a program:** a clinical team could later keep decisions in a standard format.

Source: the live app and the repository, Oct 17 2026.

Running it for real takes three steps, and none of them promises results.

1. Run it where the data lives
The engine has a local mode with no outside calls, so a coaching program runs it on its own machine and nothing leaves. The public demo uses invented examples only.

2. Clinical review before real use
A nurse and a native Spanish speaker review the flag rules (**clinical review**). Today the rules and severity tiers S1 to S3 are our own design, and the blind figure was measured on invented phrasings.

3. Next build
Per-line language detection for mixed English and Spanish calls, Kreyòl patterns, sign-in, so each decision is tied to a named reviewer, then a validation run on real, **consented** data (people agreed), reported as real numbers. After that: delivering a flag through the program's own consented, secure channel.

So what for a program: you decide what data it sees, and clinicians review the rules before use.

ASK AND SOURCES

We want one coaching program to pilot it.

A coaching or survivorship program that reviews a handful of real calls with us, under its own privacy rules.

Built from the challenge brief and dataset documentation. Not yet validated with real users or in a pilot.

Sources and credits. Challenge brief and dataset documentation: eMerge AI Hackathon, Miami AI Hub, Sylvester Comprehensive Cancer Center. Dataset used in our local evaluation (not published): AnnoMI: Wu et al., “Anno-MI: A Dataset of Expert-Annotated Counselling Dialogues,” ICASSP 2022, pp. 6177–6181. The public repository contains code only, no challenge data.

Try it: https://coachs-copilot.onrender.com · **Code:** https://github.com/theguiotine/hackathon-copilot

> **So what for a program:** a small, low-risk trial with your own data rules and a human in the loop.

Gracias. Thank you.